

Choosing Jesus Is the Cost That Finishes the Tower

Boy, I get excited thinking about it. He loved me so much that He changed forms, came, and redeemed me. I am a treasure to Him. I am a rare treasure. He is going to spend forever with me. You are a treasure.

When I give my life to see heaven filled with treasures, He moves on my behalf. My motives become eternal, and His motives become temporary on my behalf.

He said, "Seek the kingdom first. Do not stop praying. Do not stop fasting. Do not stop giving, and I will see to it that everything the Gentiles seek after will be added to you."

The devil says, "I will break you."

So I will give more.

He says, "I will fill your time so much that you will not take time to get up at four."

I say, "Yes, I will."

He says, "I am going to busy you up with so much prosperity that you will not have time to fast."

I say, "Yes, I will. I will fast while I am working."

A friend of mine fasted thirty days and pulled boards in a mill. His skin grew up so much that he could hardly close his mouth. He looked like walking death. His arms got about that big around. He spent a lot of energy pulling boards, but the hunger on the inside was stronger than the hunger on the outside.

You start praying, and God's love will flow to you and build you up to a place where He can flow through you.

Always remember: although we are going to see thousands of people born again, there will come a time when the walls will be lined with people in wheelchairs and little children who are sick and twisted up. God loves you as much as those twisted children. He loves you as much as all those people in wheelchairs. He loves you as much as all those people being born again.

That is why you must let God's love flow to you and deal with the torment, fears, and worries through the relationship of fasting, giving, and praying until you reach that impasse and whip it.

It is not just God's love flowing to you. It must begin to flow through you.

When He moves you between hell and this city, which is trying to get there, you will attract powers and principalities from around the world, and they will be bent on your destruction. But if His love has flowed to you until fear, worry, and torment have been eradicated, then you will have that

foundation of peace. The devil can pour seventeen realms of hell on you, and it will not deter you from your objective, because you cannot be stopped.

You are his worst problem. You are unmanageable because you will not take care.

A person could get excited about this.

Now you know how to humble yourself. This whole chapter is devoted to humbling yourself.

Look again at Luke 14:11:

For whosoever exalteth himself shall be abased; and he that humbleth himself shall be exalted.

Verses 25 and 26 are instructions for humbling ourselves, and we are going to go through the whole chapter verse by verse if we keep on it:

And there went great multitudes with him: and he turned, and said unto them,
If any man come to me, and hate not his father, and mother, and wife, and children, and brethren, and sisters, yea, and his own life also, he cannot be my disciple.
And whosoever doth not bear his cross, and come after me, cannot be my disciple.

Then He says:

For which of you, intending to build a tower, sitteth not down first, and counteth the cost, whether he have sufficient to finish it?
Lest haply, after he hath laid the foundation, and is not able to finish it, all that behold it begin to mock him,
Saying, This man began to build, and was not able to finish.

When He said, "Humble yourself," these are the instructions for humbling yourself. Any man who comes to Him and does not hate his father, mother, wife, children, brothers, sisters, and his own life also cannot be His disciple.

This is humbling yourself.

How many of you would camp on a chapter if that chapter offered you the information needed to receive enough building materials to finish your life in God, no matter what He has called you to?

We know He is not talking about building a natural tower. He is using that as an illustration. He is talking about you and me coming to Jesus and humbling ourselves.

He says that if any man comes to Him and does not hate father, mother, brother, and sister, that is an act of humility. He says to pick up your cross and follow Him.

The tower is your life. It is what God has called you to do for Him in the kingdom. This chapter offers you the information to make sure you have enough building materials to finish your tower.

He says you count the cost because if you fall short, everyone who saw you will mock you and say, "This man began to build and was not able to finish."

You need to count the cost. You need to know what you must do to have enough building materials.

Many of you are called to wonderful things. Many of you may be keys to the kingdom. You might be a major key God can use to bring revival to this city, where three or four thousand people are born again a week. Many of you are called to preach. Many of you are called to miracles, to miracle ministries. Many of you are called to teaching ministries that knock the hind leg right off a dog.

That is what He is talking about. Which of you, intending to build a tower, will not sit down and count the cost?

The counting of the cost is whether you are going to choose Jesus over everything that exists. If you do not, you will not have enough to finish your tower, because you have not humbled yourself and He cannot exalt you.

Let us talk about this humility.

Do you say, "I choose Jesus"?

Oh, I chose Him when He was a supplement to my life. He helped me get through this life. He helped me accomplish the name I needed to accomplish. He helped me cope with life. He was the ever-present help in time of need. Yes, I chose Him to that degree.

But I am choosing Him more now. I do not want Him to be just a supplement to my life. I want to be a conqueror.

He guarantees me in this chapter that I can have enough building materials to finish my tower if I humble myself. The act of humility is this:

If any man come to me, and hate not his father, and mother, and wife, and children, and brethren, and sisters, yea, and his own life also, he cannot be my disciple.

Notice how He chose the things nearest to us in this life.

When it gets to heaven, Scripture says we will be like the angels in one sense: we neither marry nor are given in marriage. Although you recognize your past life, your husband, your wife, and your children, there is a whole other sense of completeness and no sense of lack in heaven.

Your wife is still your wife from the past, but she becomes a sister. There is a closeness you will never lose, but she is a sister.

In this life, Jesus chose the things closest to us when He named father, mother, wife, children, brothers, and sisters. Then He added our own life also.

To hate my own life. If you do not pick up your cross and follow Him, you cannot be His disciplined follower. Everybody knows what happens on a cross: you are crucified. That is where the old man dies.

When He says to hate your own life also, and to pick up your cross, He is talking about following Jesus and crucifying the old man, his wants, and all his desires on the cross. This act of humility is part of the qualification for having enough building materials to finish your tower.

But I could not get past this. I said, "Jesus, You said that if any man comes to You and hates not his father, mother, brother, and sisters--You picked all the things closest to a man in this life. What kind of hate are You talking about? It cannot be violent hate that carries animosity, that says, 'You did something to me; I hate your guts.'"

We know Jesus cannot be talking about that. He is not. But He is talking about an emotion every bit as powerful.

Any man who comes to Him and does not violently, vehemently, emphatically choose Him over family, over wife, father, mother, brothers, sisters--yes, over everything--cannot be His disciple.

If you love them, you will choose Him. If you do not choose Him, you will not have enough building materials to finish your tower. In that tower is the promise of your family.

He is not telling you that you will lose them. He is telling you that you will gain them because you have chosen Him.

It seems I can hardly sit down anymore. There is a room inside, and it is almost as if all that is required is to get quiet for a moment. He turns the light on in that room, and that is where I go to visit Him. I go in there, and that is when I turn on. That is where His voice is.

It seems I can barely sit down and bask in His presence for a moment before He turns the light on and says, "Roberson, do you know this? Do you know this? Do you know this?"

He has been talking to me like this for six months. I had heard Him before, but not like now. He has been talking to me since I came into that incredible foundation of peace six or seven months ago, a place I had never walked in before.

If you had asked me five years ago, "Are you walking in peace, Brother Roberson?" I would have said, "Yes, the peace of God that passes all understanding." I had nothing to compare it to. Peace is relative.

Jesus said, "My peace I give unto you, not as the world gives. Let not your heart be troubled." There is no troubling of heart in that room. It is the most incredible thing. It is the love of God, and it is preparation for things to come. I could tell you about it all night, but I would have to bring you to the water hole and make you drink.

Now I can say, "Yes, I was walking in a measure of peace, but not like now."

Glory to God.

He must live in a castle of peace. When I counsel people full of troubles, I feel like asking, "Where is the light switch?"

He told me one day, "Help them. Help them; they are little babies. Help them. But as long as they are looking for the answer on the outside, they do not have it, because the answer is on the inside."

I said, "Yes, I know that now."

He said, "Minister to them. They cannot hear Me if I run over them with a bulldozer. They will look at you and listen to you. You tell them."

Your problems are irrelevant. All of you are going to face horrible obstacles if we are going to bring revival. The devil will try to checkmate you every foot of the way. You will face obstacles that are absolutely horrible and at times life-threatening. I have been there.

But if you are going to have revival, you might as well look at the end and treat everything that comes against you like Paul said:

I take pleasure in necessities, persecutions, and distresses.

It is just another obstacle in the way. Get it out of the way.

"I do not have enough money."

Just another obstacle.

"I do not have time to pray. I am working two jobs that consume fourteen hours a day."

Just another obstacle. The same common temptations, testings, and trials stopped everyone else who quit seeking first the kingdom and His righteousness.

So I sat down, and the light came on. He began to talk.

He said, "Do you want to know what I mean by, 'If any man comes to Me and hates not his father, mother, brothers, and sisters'? I asked you to choose Me, did I not?"

I said, "Yes, sir."

He said, "You could do for your family until you conquered the world. You could be a single world ruler and possess all the wealth of the world. You could give your mother, father, brothers, sisters, wife, and old life the wealth of Solomon. You could set them up as kings and give them the utmost desires of their hearts, whatever they could ever dream of. In comparison to what I have prepared for those who love Me, all that you could give them would appear as hate if you caused them to lose their reward by not choosing Me."

He said, "It would all look like you hated them if you did not choose Me and lead them into the reward I have prepared for them in eternity. All you can do on this earth for them, even if they owned the whole world and the wealth of Solomon, would appear as though you hated them if they lose their reward in heaven."

So if any man comes to Him and does not hate father, mother, brother, sister, wife, and his own life also--meaning he does not choose Jesus violently and vehemently--then all he can conquer, accomplish, and gather to himself would appear as though he hated himself in the end if he loses his reward.

Pick up your cross. Follow Him.

Which of you, intending to build a tower, would not sit down and calculate inflation right down to the last nail?

He said, "That is what you are doing when you choose Me with everything in you. You are calculating inflation right down to the end, and I will guarantee you exaltation. Humble yourself and I will exalt you. I will make sure you have enough to finish your tower."

I might not be your hero here, but if you walk with us, we will be your hero in heaven. If I set you up here and lie to you here, then I might as well have hated you.

Yes, He said, "If any man comes to Me and hates not..." because in comparison, the best I can do for you in this life would look like hate if you miss your reward over there.

Jesus turned to the multitude and said, "If any man comes to Me..."

Then He concluded:

So likewise, whosoever he be of you that forsaketh not all that he hath, he cannot be my disciple.

Look again at verse 26:

If any man come to me, and hate not his father, and mother, and wife, and children, and brethren, and sisters, yea, and his own life also, he cannot be my disciple.

And whosoever doth not bear his cross, and come after me, cannot be my disciple.

If you do not choose Jesus, then you will have hated them.

Then He says:

For which of you, intending to build a tower, sitteth not down first, and counteth the cost, whether he have sufficient to finish it?

And:

Or what king, going to make war against another king, sitteth not down first, and consulteth whether he be able with ten thousand to meet him that cometh against him with twenty thousand?

Or else, while the other is yet a great way off, he sendeth an ambassage, and desireth conditions of peace.

Then verse 33 says:

So likewise, whosoever he be of you that forsaketh not all that he hath, he cannot be my disciple.

"Likewise" is a comparative word. "Like" means He is comparing you to something or someone He has already spoken about. "Wise" means you had better be wise enough to conform to it.

He is comparing you to two men: first, the man who did not have enough to finish his tower; second, the man who did not have counsel available to know whether to go against twenty thousand with his ten thousand, or to send ambassadors of peace.

He says you are like both of these if you do not forsake all that you have.

Does that not sound like verse 26? "If any man comes to Me and hates not his father, mother, wife, and children..." Likewise, whoever does not forsake all that he has cannot be My disciple.

You are like the man who did not have enough to finish his tower. You are like the man who had no counsel available. You are like both if you do not choose Jesus violently, vehemently, emphatically, with everything in you.

The next verse says:

Salt is good: but if the salt have lost his savour, wherewith shall it be seasoned?

If you take the salty flavor out of salt, where are you going to go to season it back? Jesus said it is not even fit for the dunghill.

What He is saying is this: it is no great loss to choose Jesus, because outside of Jesus in this entire universe, where are you going to go to replace what He is in your life?

Salt is good. If salt loses its flavor, what are you going to season it back with? He is not asking you to fail. He is asking you to succeed.

Outside of Jesus, where are you going to get that kind of building material? Nowhere.

There is only one way He guarantees you exaltation, and that is to humble yourself under the mighty hand of God. That is to choose Jesus. To choose Jesus is to choose His Word. To choose His Word is to choose Him.

I remember my first stands. I will close with this.

When I found out that Jesus bore my sicknesses and carried my pains, I had been tricked for a lot of years. I drew a line and said, "If Jesus said it, I believe it, and it is so."

Because I have chosen Jesus, I have chosen His Word.

John 1 says:

| In the beginning was the Word, and the Word was with God, and the Word was God.

I have chosen Jesus; I have chosen the Word. I drew a line because before that I did not know how to sell out. Now I do.

To choose the Word is to choose Jesus.

Himself has borne my sicknesses and carried my pains. Listen to me, devil: I am going to pull that Scripture out, put my feet on that rock of doing His sayings, and violently, vehemently, emphatically choose Jesus.

So, take your best shot, because they will find me standing on this rock when Jesus comes back. One of us is going to give, and it is not going to be me.

I do not care how much fasting, praying, and giving it takes. I am not moving off the rock, because I have chosen Jesus. There is only one way exaltation comes: by humbling yourself and choosing Jesus. To choose Jesus is to choose His Word.

I know what God's will is for this city. He has told me. I choose revival. I do not care what exists between us and revival. I choose it. Everything that gets in the way is nothing more than an obstacle that needs to be removed.

I choose Jesus.

You are quiet tonight. You are all looking at me like you want me to say more.

I am teaching entirely differently now. I have series that I have taught in revival for years that I could give you. This is the in-between stuff. I say that because I am teaching totally by the flow of the Holy Spirit. When I hear you pulling, I feel it and go on. When you stop, I stop. If I feel you pulling and not understanding, I will work it fifteen times. I am moving in the Spirit differently than I ever have before.

How many of you choose Jesus?

Thank You, Father.

Yes, count it joy when you fall into temptations and testings. For you may know this: when your faith is put on trial, it will work patience, and patience will work these things in your life, that you may become mature, entire, and lacking nothing.

So count it all joy and place your feet solidly on the rock. Let nothing depart out of your mouth that is not faith talk, for you must come to Him believing that He is the rewarder of those who diligently seek Him.

Stand fast in the liberty wherewith I have made you free, and continue to do those things in My Spirit that will produce. You will see.

For when My joy and My peace sustain you through everything that will come, you will see in your life that I will leave no good thing undone. You shall eat from the horn of plenty, and you will know Me well in a time of trouble, for I am the Lord your God who supplies all your needs according to My riches in glory.

Therefore rejoice and be exceedingly glad. Flow in My mind and understand the things I would work, the things I desire to have, and you will see revival will come. It will come soon. You will see. This revival will come, and in the process you will be made free.

Hallelujah. Just stay in His presence another moment.

In the name of Jesus Christ, I am the Lord your God, and you will see revival will come. Yes, I am the Lord your God, and you will see revival will come, and in the process you will be made free.

I desire to move for you. Untie My hands, that I may flow through your life to bring things to you. As any good father, I desire to give you those keys that unlock those doors, that within your heart you will have peace and will not know what it is to want anymore.

Your fellowship and supplication will be such with Me that long before the victory arrives at your doorstep, inside you will have been made free.

Know this: in the world you will have persecutions, and tribulations will always come your way, but I have overcome and I have placed peace within you.

I desire to fellowship with you. Let Me have My way, for I will dominate you in realms of authority you never knew existed. Peace, peace, peace is the order of every day. It releases Me to cause the abundant blessings to flow your way.

Walk with Me. Be a child. Be of those who have been set free, for it is your Father's good pleasure, My little ones, to open these doors and give you the keys to the kingdom.

Stand up and walk My way, saith the Spirit of grace, for I have made you ten feet tall in My Spirit. You need not fear. You need not live in distresses and perplexities.

My peace, the peace that surpasses understanding, is the domain where I would have you reign. It is the place I would have you conquer. It is the labor I would have you strive for.

Labor to enter into My rest, for you have yet, My children, to taste My best. There is a place where you can fly free and soar with the eagles. It is in Me.

Rejoice and be exceedingly glad, and count it all joy, for the victory was delivered two thousand years ago. My children, it is yours. It is had.

That is good. That is so good.

Does anybody else in here feel a whole lot of peace?

Yes, yes, yes. I can see that.

As you strive and labor to enter into this rest, the testimony services will be extremely blessed, for you will share things that have never been heard before.

I have yet to cause you to understand the kind of blessings I have prepared for you from before. Testimonies will come forth of exceeding joy.

Those testimonies will be of the kind, saith the Spirit of grace, of the treasury, the kind that will fill the lofty high place, My dwelling place.

Testimonies will come in from your relatives around the world, that they do not serve under the prince of darkness anymore, that they have come through My door.

You will esteem the treasures of heaven more than life itself, and you will see it will be the power of My anointing that takes you off the shelf.

You will be a warrior of the highest degree. You will cause things to happen in My Spirit. You will release Me with authority, and through you I will set people free.

Prepare yourself, children, with the armor of the day. Enter into warfare and prepare yourself to stay. Be of such who burns the bridge behind and says, "I am in it for the duration. I am in it for all time. I will contend until Your glory fills this place. O Lord, I desire to see Your will manifested."

I can remember when I used my faith to believe for things, which I still do. I love them. But it did not quench something that has consumed me.

Only in the last six months have I had the contentment beginning to satisfy a craving I have had since God knows when. Like Jesus said, "My meat is to do the will of Him who sent Me."

I am going to tell you now: I do not care what you achieve in this life, it will not quench the thirst. If you have a business and are called to helps, prayer, and making a lot of money for the gospel, you may have an ability to make a lot of money, but it will not quench until your money is laying treasures up in heaven.

It is not worth one restless night on your bed.

Do you know what it means to lie back, close your eyes full of peace and contentment, and know you gave the devil trouble that day?

There is a wave of glory about ready to come through here, and it is a deep-seated [unclear].